

inventor; there were others who tried to copy his idea, plagiarize, but the original will always stand tall and it did. A much recognized technocrat, Vikas has also received the prestigious "Eminent Engineer Award 2018" on behalf of Maharashtra & Goa state, conferred by Indian Society for Technical Education, New Delhi.

As Managing Director of Savi Infrastructures & Properties Pvt. Ltd., Vikas Patil's special gives to the industry are twofold; an advanced controlled yielding technique with zero pressure concept that is a unique solution for retaining walls with greater heights and the patented 'Graviloff', with which design and construction of retaining structures can be effectively done in line with the concept of construction-friendly methodologies. Work is certainly worship for this engineer. From the early part of 2017, when he received a 40 million INR grant from MHRD, Govt. of India for the research proposal submitted at IIT Bombay under UAY_2017 Phase II, it has been a long and fast paced journey up to the time when today, he is the sole and widely acknowledged expert for design & build solutions for 25m and 30m height of retention wall. It is a high risk and high tech area of expertise where his patent, skill and work culture has meant that his professional chart and order book is brimming with contracts. His collaborations with various corporates, MNCs and Government organizations have given him a formidable reputation without parallel. With a strong team that is loyal to the core concept, his company is an example of working together towards the greater goal.

Despite the accolades and the surmounting of hundreds of challenges successfully and in style, Vikas Patil the dreamer still remains intact. When it came to designing his own bungalow in an upmarket part of Pune, he insisted on putting in the right things, the latest tech, whatever the time and cost. It is no wonder that the large windows on all sides of his home somewhat represent an incredibly open minded way of looking at problems, people, situations and goals.

Every company yearns for a glorious past, an exciting present and a legacy that will carry its weight into the next era. Malhar, Vikas Patil's son represents this in more ways than one; for starts, he carries his father's love for cars and bikes and the good things in life, and secondly, with his post-graduation in precisely the same field – Geotechnical Engineering- Malhar, with his studies at the prestigious UC Berkeley, matches his father with a humility and vision that is good news for the company.

For every successful technocrat, it is easy to get carried away on the horses of fame, acclaim and

acknowledgement but Vikas Patil has been there, done that. "In my village, it was a different world; my mother was not an educated woman but she gave me what mattered most- a grounded approach and a way of managing men with tact, unity and perseverance. Today, Savi Infrastructures is what it is owing to the effort of our team; it is who we are that matters most."

This firm eye to the ground at all times is perhaps the reason why, despite the huge time commitments his work demands, he still takes time out for the small and important things that matter. Interestingly, Vikas Patil the go-getter businessman is both similar and different from the engineer in him. As current Chairman of IGS (Indian Geotechnical Society Pune Chapter), he likes to work in a team, stay low profile and project the strength of the organization rather than a personal front. He plans to enrol the students of engineering colleges as members of IGS so that the very critical field of geotechnical engineering will get its worth and upgrade the level of excellence.

In a sector that is often fraught with unprofessional approach, colossal wastage and time delays, this man wants to spearhead a huge shift in the way we look at construction. That, he says, would give him maximum satisfaction. As he quotes from a famous railroad magnate, 'Connections are made from the

heart and through the soil; ultimately both carry veins and arteries that run on integrity, the sweat of the brow and deep rooted effort."

Today, after his trailblazing ride on India's roads and highways and bridges, the visionary in Vikas Patil yearns for this technology to reach foreign shores. In keeping with the dreamer he is, this longing is not merely for his company; he craves for the world to come knocking at India's doors, for India to be recognized worldwide as a destination of innovative ideas and novel construction techniques. This, he says, is for next generation to do, and with son Malhar soon joining him, it would herald the next chapter in the journey of Savi Infrastructures & Properties Pvt. Ltd. In many ways, he says, it is like going back to the villages- where you work with your heart and for the soil, simply for the incomparable satisfaction of seeing the bumper crop as it sways in the breeze. Much like the name his family chose for their bungalow, it is all about the 'beej' – the germ of an idea that grows and reaches out to a new world.

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